

» WADERS, GULLS,
AND AUKS

28–31 cm
11–12 in

BRONZE-WINGED JACANA
Metopidius indicus
F: Jacanidae

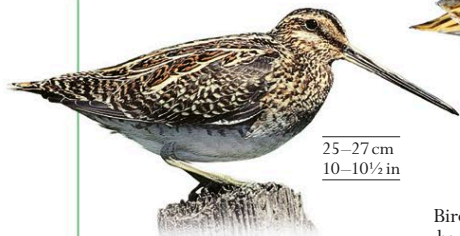
This species is widespread across India and S.E. Asia. Males have a flattened "forearm" bone that helps them lift chicks with their wings.



23–26 cm
9–10 in

GREATER PAINTED-SNIPE
Rostratula benghalensis
F: Rostratulidae

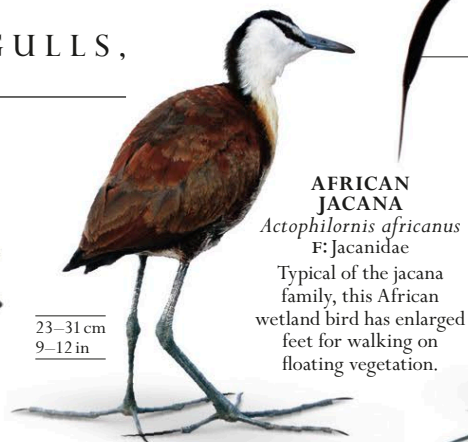
Related to the jacanas, the short-legged painted-snipes share their female-dominant mating system. This bird is from Old World tropical wetlands.



25–27 cm
10–10½ in

COMMON SNIPE
Gallinago gallinago
F: Scolopacidae

Typical of waders, chicks of this globally widespread species are active soon after hatching. Unlike other waders, snipes feed their chicks.



23–31 cm
9–12 in

AFRICAN JACANA
Actophilornis africanus
F: Jacanidae
Typical of the jacana family, this African wetland bird has enlarged feet for walking on floating vegetation.



15–19 cm
6–7½ in

PLAINS WANDERER
Pedionomus torquatus
F: Pedionomidae

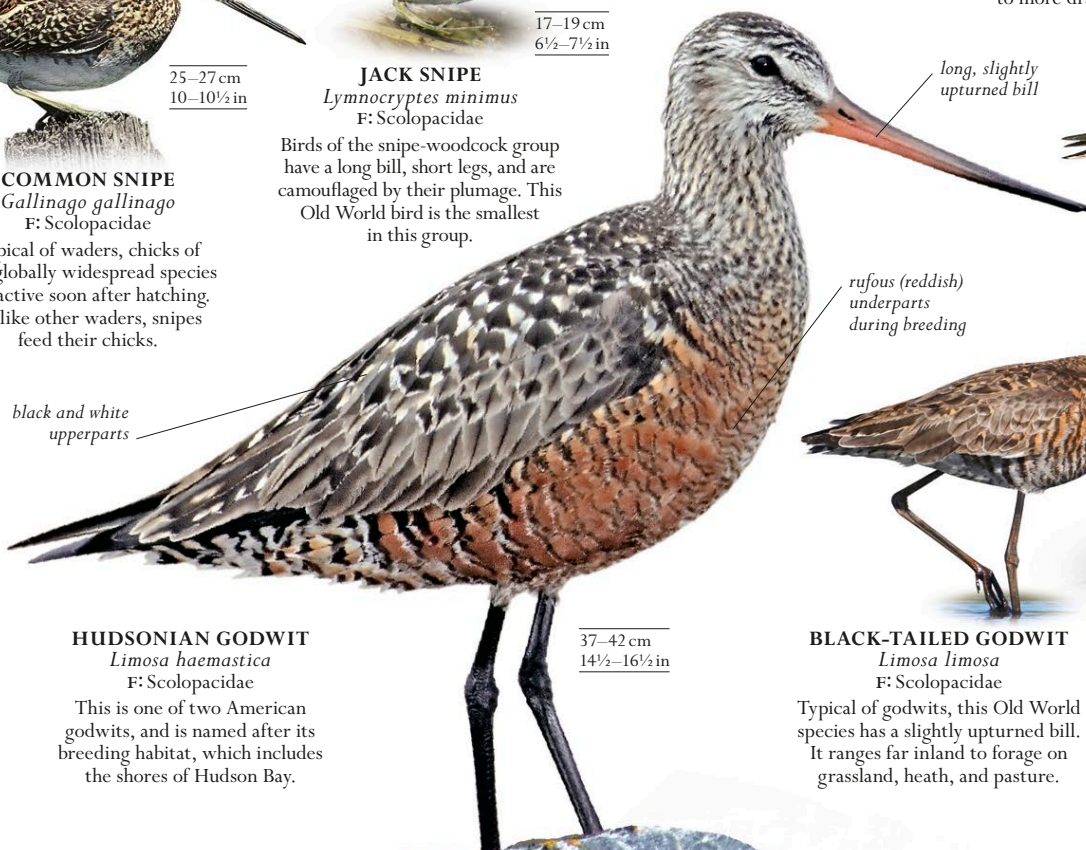
This quail-like bird of Australian grassland – the only member of its family – is actually related to the wetland jacanas.



17–19 cm
6½–7½ in

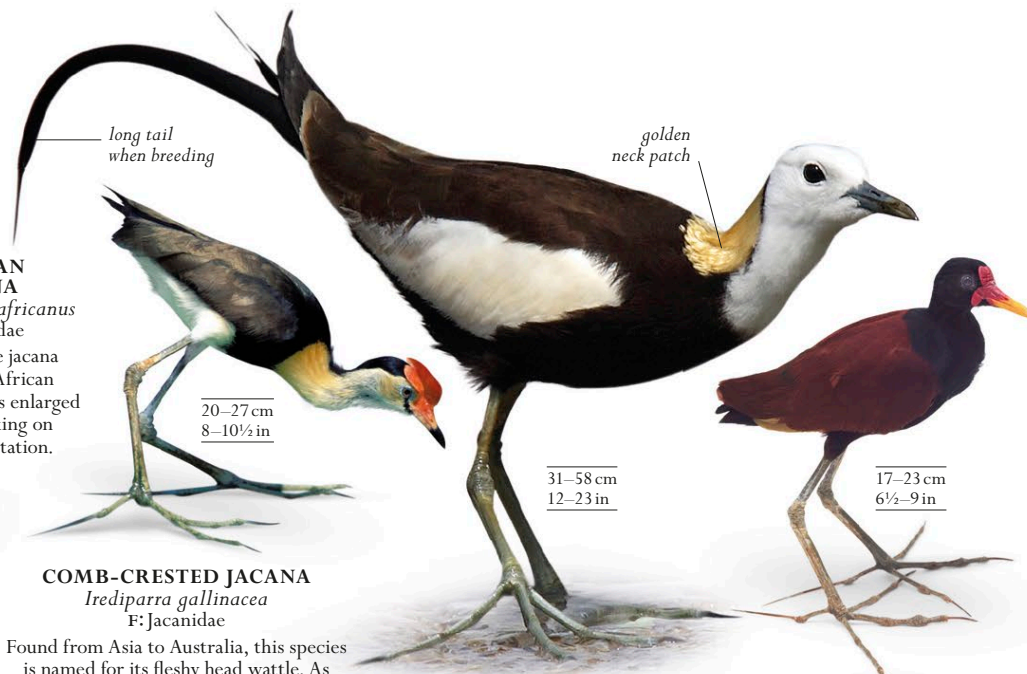
JACK SNIPE
Limnocyrtus minimus
F: Scolopacidae

Birds of the snipe-woodcock group have a long bill, short legs, and are camouflaged by their plumage. This Old World bird is the smallest in this group.



HUDSONIAN GODWIT
Limosa haemastica
F: Scolopacidae

This is one of two American godwits, and is named after its breeding habitat, which includes the shores of Hudson Bay.



20–27 cm
8–10½ in

COMB-CRESTED JACANA
Irediparra gallinacea
F: Jacanidae

Found from Asia to Australia, this species is named for its fleshy head wattle. As with other jacanas, males incubate the eggs and care for the young.



23–25 cm
9–10 in

SHORT-BILLED DOWITCHER
Limnodromus griseus
F: Scolopacidae

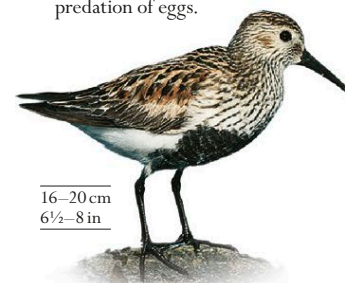
Dowitchers are related to snipes and are reddish coloured in their breeding plumage. The short-billed dowitcher is confined to the Americas.



23–25 cm
9–10 in

RED KNOT
Calidris canutus
F: Scolopacidae

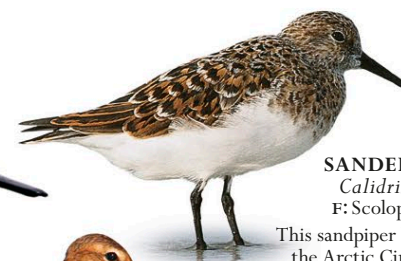
Like many migratory waders, the Arctic-breeding red knot moults its distinctive summer plumage to more drab colours in winter.



16–20 cm
6½–8 in

DUNLIN
Calidris alpina
F: Scolopacidae

Globally common, the dunlin is typical of waders that breed around the Arctic and flock to the warmer south in the winter.



20–21 cm
8–8½ in

SANDERLING
Calidris alba
F: Scolopacidae

This sandpiper breeds within the Arctic Circle, further north than other waders. In winter, it flocks on sandy shores further south.



40–44 cm
16–17½ in

BLACK-TAILED GODWIT
Limosa limosa
F: Scolopacidae

Typical of godwits, this Old World species has a slightly upturned bill. It ranges far inland to forage on grassland, heath, and pasture.



18–19 cm
7–7½ in

RED-NECKED PHALAROPE
Phalaropus lobatus
F: Scolopacidae

This species has a breeding range that includes much of the Arctic region. Females are brightly coloured and attract males with displays during breeding; males care for offspring.